From Zero to Mesh

Secure, Resilient Traffic Between Your Services with Kong Mesh

2026-10-29

Dustin Krysak, Staff Technical CSM

© Kong Inc.



How much do you use a mesh today?

A Not using one

B Evaluating

C In production on Kubernetes

D In production on VMs

© Kong Inc.

Three jobs

1

Retry

2

Identity

3

Failover

© Kong Inc.

Why a mesh

1

Sidecar

Beside each app

2

Control plane

Sends the rules

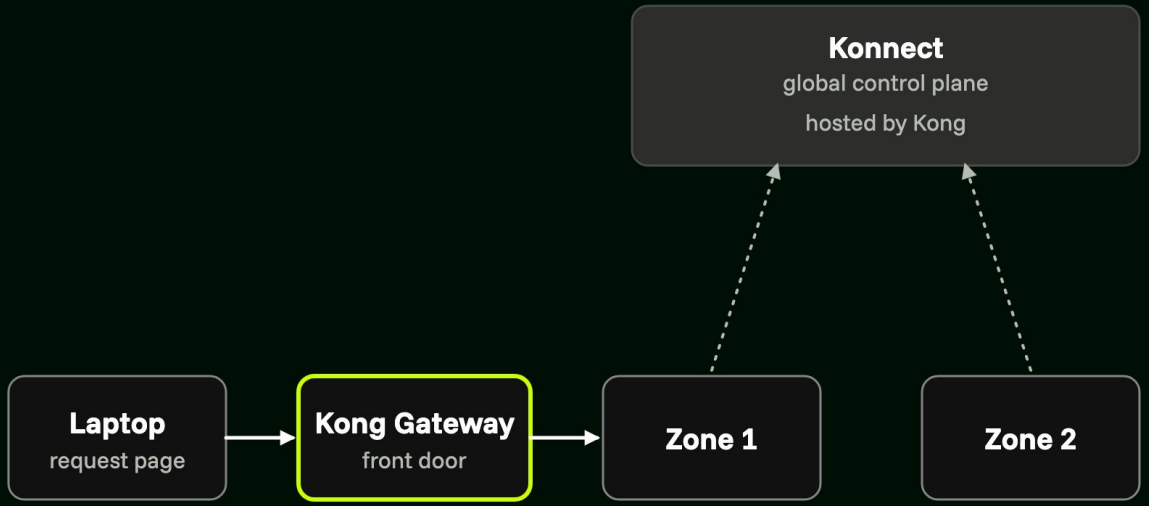
© Kong Inc.

What you will see

1. Two Kubernetes zones
2. Gateway: the front door
3. Konnect: control plane
4. A live request page

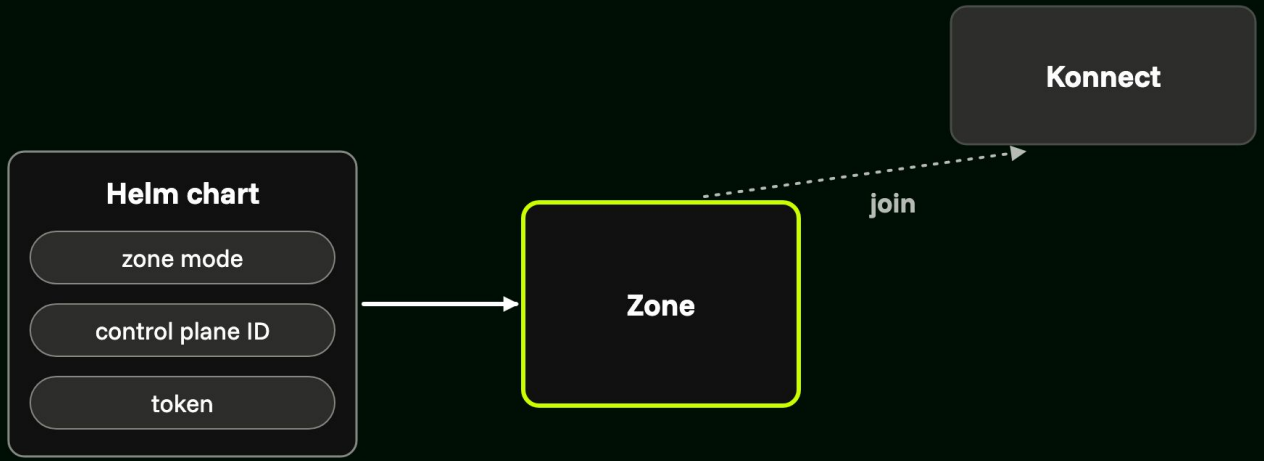
© Kong Inc.

How it fits



© Kong Inc.

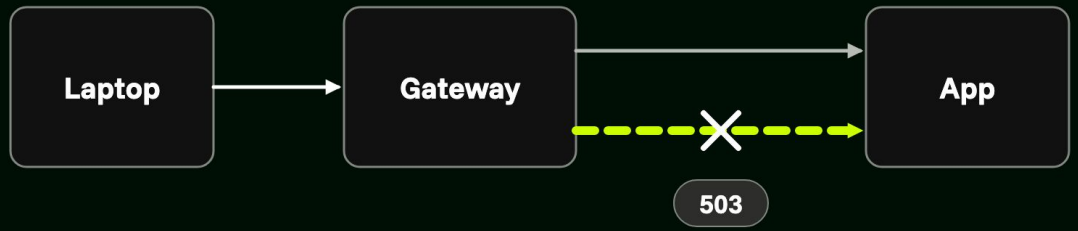
Install and join



© Kong Inc.

Baseline

95 of 200 failed



no policy

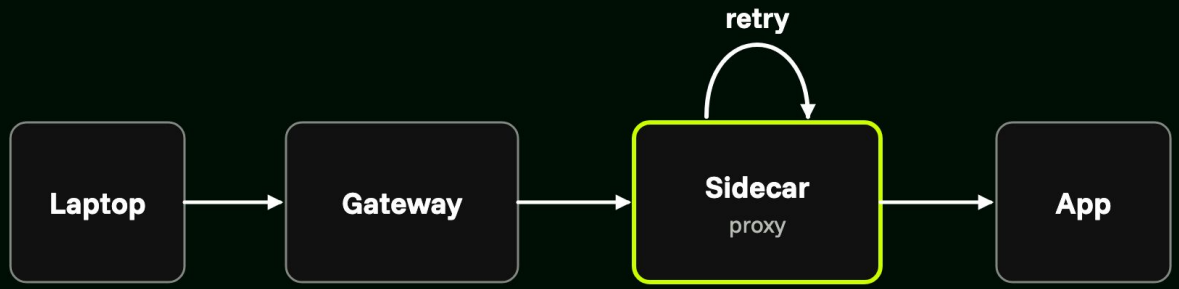
© Kong Inc.

Can one policy hide a failure?

© Kong Inc.

Retry

up to 3 tries on a 503



13 of 200

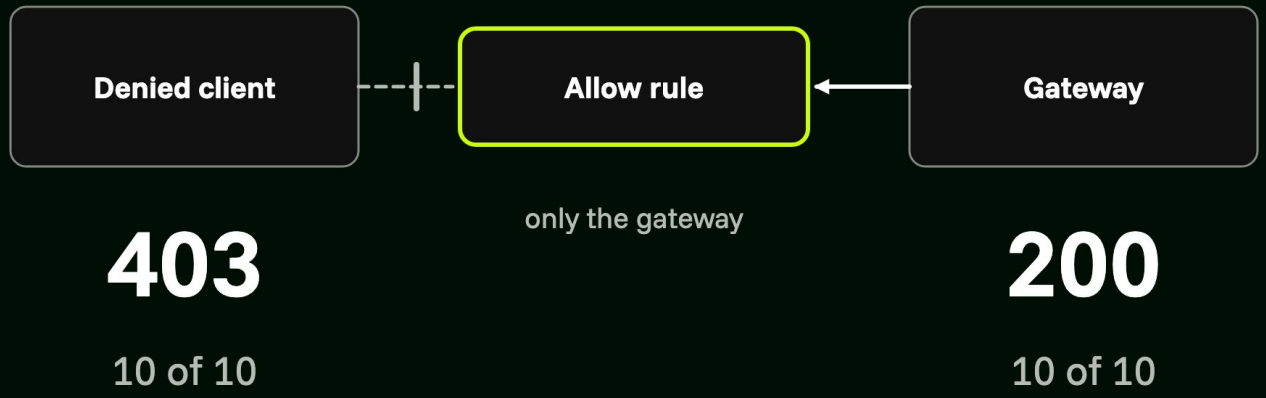
failed

© Kong Inc.

Who may call whom?

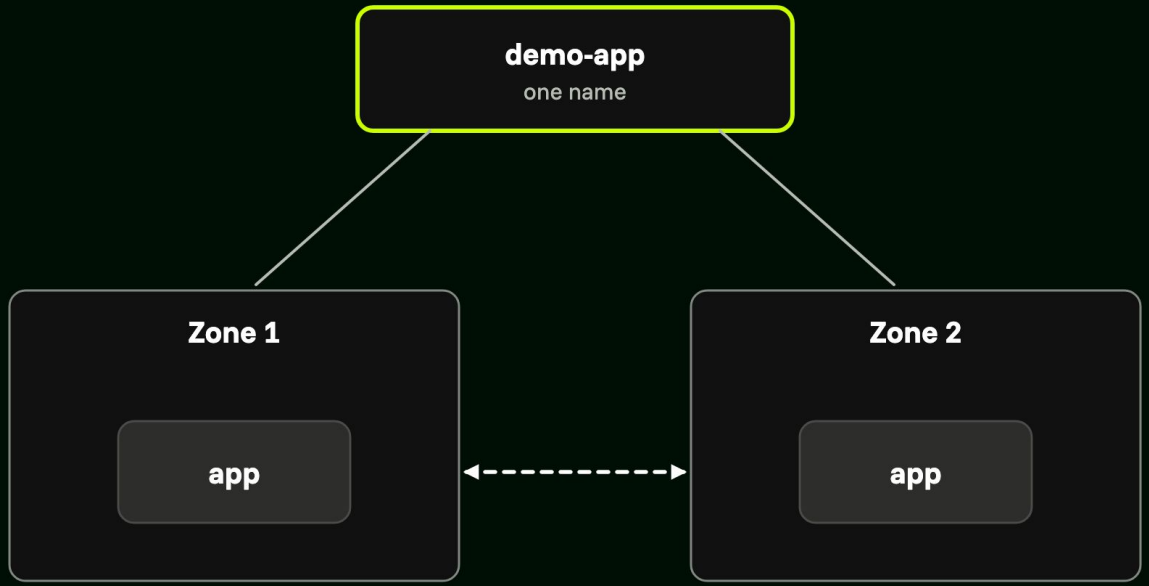
© Kong Inc.

Identity



© Kong Inc.

One service, two zones

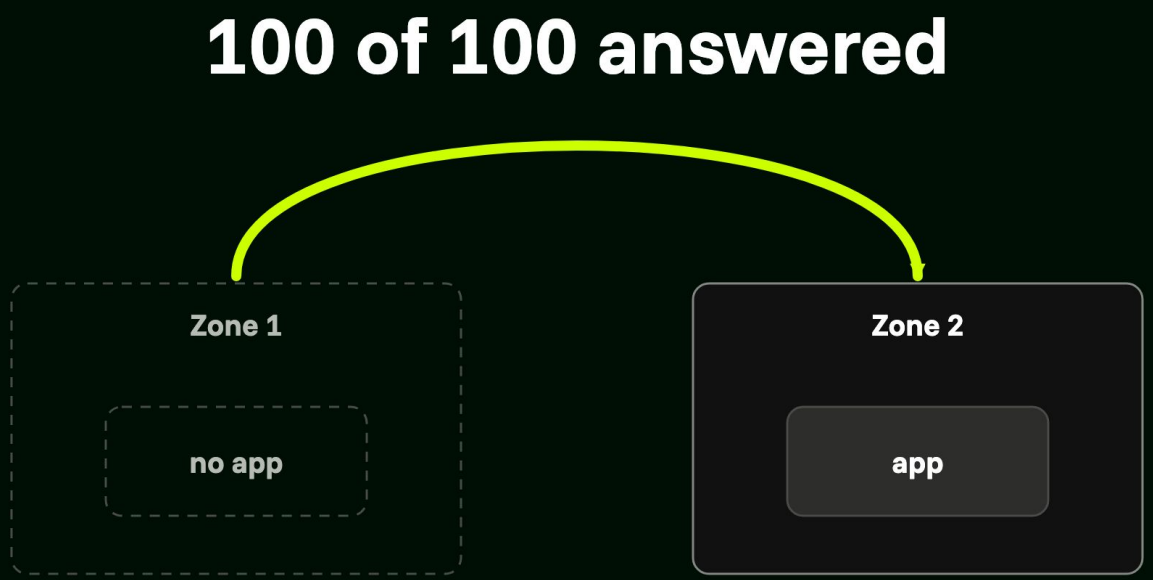


© Kong Inc.

What if zone 1 loses its app?

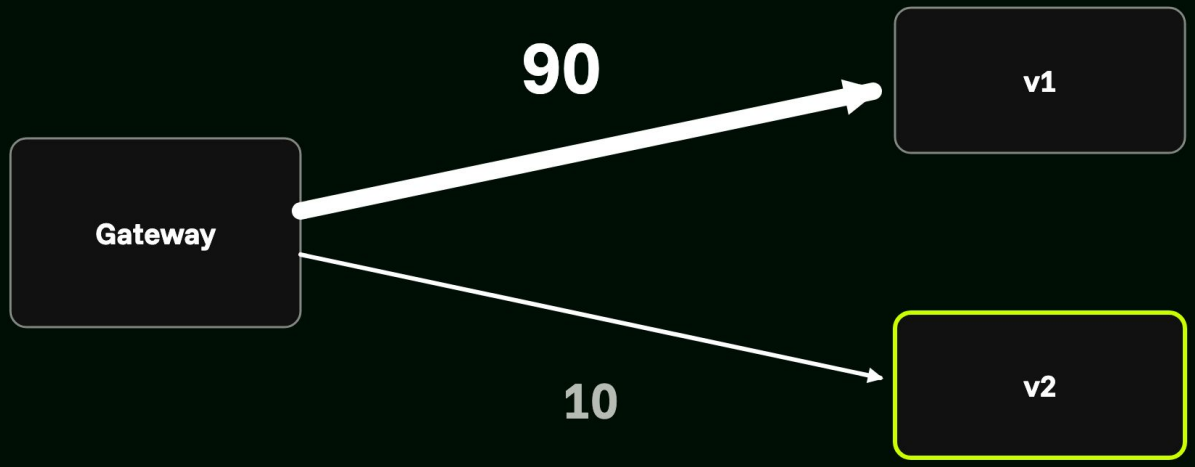
© Kong Inc.

Failover



© Kong Inc.

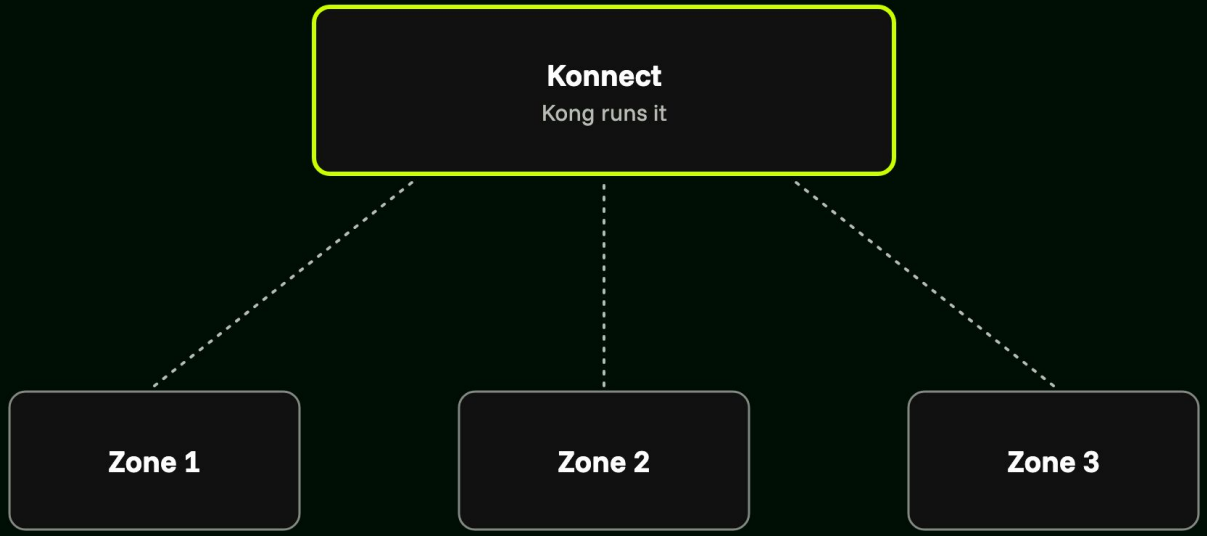
Canary (stretch)



no app change

© Kong Inc.

What you do not run



you run none

© Kong Inc.

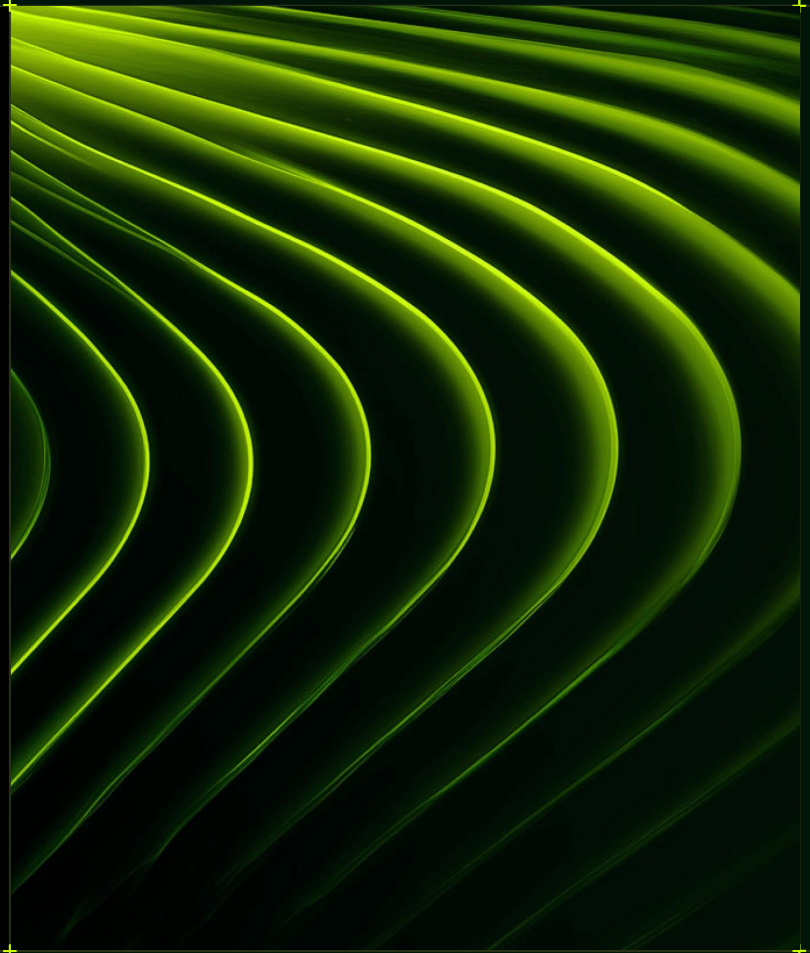
Key takeaways

1. Retry hides failures
2. Identity limits callers
3. Failover moves traffic

© Kong Inc.

Go deeper

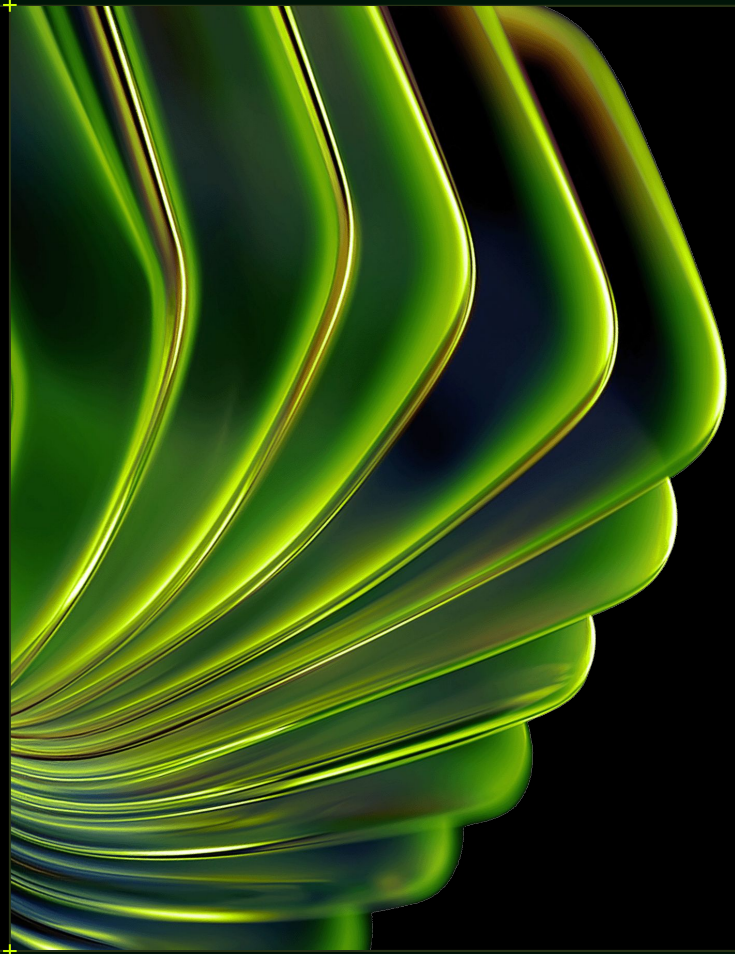
- Zone proxies
- Locality-aware load balancing
- MeshExternalService



© Kong Inc.

Resources and download

- Everything shown is in the download
- Link: https://github.com/KongHQ-CX/cs-webinars/releases/tag/2026-10-from-zero-to-mesh
- Configs and demo scripts



© Kong Inc.

Thank you



Kong Inc.
dustin.krysak@kong.ai

Konghq.com

© Kong Inc.